CONCEPT NOTE

Theme: **AI for a Resilient ASEAN: Innovation, Sustainability, and Humanity**

1. BACKGROUND

As the ASEAN region accelerates toward a projected **$1 trillion digital economy by 2030**, Artificial Intelligence (AI) has emerged not only as a tool for efficiency but as the definitive cornerstone for ethical growth and regional resilience. However, the path to this prosperity is obstructed by pressing regional and global crises: **the climate emergency, healthcare inequities, rapid urban transformation, and the urgent need for future-ready education.**

The **ASEAN AI Council (AAIC)**, with the strategic support of the **Passage to ASEAN (P2A)** and collaboration of **Duy Tan University (DTU)**, recognizes that bridging the 'Digital Divide' requires a human-centric, multi-disciplinary approach to innovation. These global challenges define the **four critical tracks** of this competition, representing the frontiers where ASEAN's survival and global competitiveness meet.

This Hackathon serves as a high-impact bridge between academic theory and industry exigency. By focusing on **Climate Resilience, Public Health, Smart Cities, and Future Learning**, we task the next generation of innovators with creating AI solutions that are technologically robust and effective, while also being inclusive, ethical, and culturally resonant, ensuring a resilient and sustainable ASEAN for all.

2. OBJECTIVES

The ASEAN AI Hackathon aims to achieve a multi-dimensional impact, focusing on talent development, technological ingenuity, and regional unity:

- **Enhancing Future-Ready Competencies:** Building AI, Cloud, and Agile skills to bridge the gap between classroom learning and the global job market.
- **Catalyzing Human-Centric Innovation:** Using AI (ML, NLP, CV) to create solutions that prioritize human well-being and regional progress.
- **Architecting Regional Resilience:** Developing scalable, sustainable AI applications tailored to ASEAN's unique challenges.
- **Cultivating a Transnational Ecosystem:** Fostering a "One ASEAN" spirit through cross-cultural collaboration across the region.
- **Promoting Strategic Regional Hubs:** Positioning Da Nang as a "Silicon Hub" where regional talent, policy, and technology converge.

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3. SCOPE AND FOCUS AREAS: Four main challenge tracks:

1. **Climate Change Resilience:** Focuses on disaster mitigation, emergency response, and addressing the impacts of climate change.
2. **Public Health & Telemedicine:** Focuses on advancing public healthcare systems and digital health solutions.
3. **Smart City:** Include Mobility & Urban Sustainability. Focuses on intelligent transportation, urban digital transformation, and integrating environmental protection and sustainability into smart city development.
4. **AI for Education:** Focuses on applying AI across all levels of education to enhance learning experiences and accessibility.

4. PROCEDURAL GUIDELINES

4.1. Participation: from ASEAN Institutions.

- **Number of teams per IHE:** 2-5 teams
- **Teams:** 3 to 5 members from the same institution (multi-disciplinary teams combining technical (IT) and non-technical (Domain-specific) students)
- One coordinator per IHE.
- At least one mentor within the respective discipline.

4.2. Platform: Sessions will be conducted via **Zoom Meeting**

5. PROPOSED SCHEDULE (subjects to change)

Timeline	Activity & Key Objective	Actions
ROUND 1: Registration		
Feb – Mar 01	**Team Registration** **Via ContactASEAN / emails**	• ASEAN institutions call for registers and form teams of **3 - 5 members** • Assign mentor for each team • Assign 1 coordinator per institution • ASEAN institutions submit Participant list to P2A (Teams+Mentors+Coordinator)
ROUND 2: Launch & Submission		
Mar 24 (6 hours)	***Morning Session*** **Opening Ceremony** **Workshop 1** ***Afternoon Session***	• Attend the Opening Ceremony • Join Workshop 1+2: Innovation Mindset, Domain Context and AI basics. • Brainstorming (under the provided 4 tracks)

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	Workshop 2 **Via Zoom Meeting**	
Mar 27	**Submit Initial Draft** **Via ContactASEAN/emails**	• Submit a **1-page Concept Note/ Technical Pitch Deck** to P2A.
Mar 30 (6 hours)	***Morning Session*** **Workshop 3** + Consultation ***Afternoon Session*** **Workshop 4 +** Consultation **Via Zoom Meeting**	• Attend Technical Workshop 2 & 3 Deep-dive into AI tech and domain-specific problem validation • Get expert advice to improve your technical plan.
Apr 10	**Preliminary Project Submission:** Submit teams' detailed project abstract. **Via ContactASEAN/emails**	• Develop your prototype. • Submit your full project description (hard deadline)
Apr 11 - 19	**Grading & Top 20 Selection**	Mentors from Technical Committee
Apr 20	**Announcement of Top 20:** Select Top 5 teams per track.	• Check results; Top 20 teams prepare for the Mentorship phase.
ROUND 3: Mentorship & Semi-Finals		
Apr 23	**E-Consultation** **Via Zoom Meeting**	• Top 20 Student teams join **E-consultation** breakout rooms as assigned.
Apr 28	**Semi-Final Round (Virtual):** pitching to select the Finalists. **Via Zoom Meeting**	• Top 20 Student teams submit Recording Pitching Video: 3-minute presentation + 3-minute Q&A.
May 3	**Result Announcement:** Selecting the **Top 8 Finalist Teams**. **Via ContactASEAN/emails**	• Top prepare **Product Promotion Video** (1-1.5 min) • Prepare to travel to Danang, Vietnam.
May 10	**Product Promotion Video Submission** **Via ContactASEAN/emails**	Top 8 teams submit Video Promotion for **Online Voting**

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May 11 - 17	**Online Voting OnContactASEAN/Facebook**	Online Voting on Social Media Channel
ROUND 4: Grand Finale		
TBC	**On-site Event at Duy Tan University (DTU):** Final Live Pitch during the ASEAN AI Summit.	• **Finalists:** Travel to Danang • Final coding sprint and **Live Pitch at DTU**.

6. PROJECT EXPECTATION

Teams are expected to deliver a comprehensive **AI Innovation Portfolio**. This portfolio proves that your solution is technically sound, ethically designed, and ready for the real world.

6.1. Core Outputs: Your team must submit the following mandatory components:

Output	Format	Key Content Requirements
1. Technical Pitch Deck *Round 2 (Submission)*	PDF (Max 15 Slides)	• Problem-Solution Fit • AI Architecture (Models & Tools) • Data Strategy & Ethics • Scalability Roadmap
2.Code Repository & Prototype *Round 3 (Semi-Finals)*	GitHub Link + Demo URL	• Clean, documented Source Code • Functional Prototype (Web/App/PoC) • Video screen-cast of the AI in action
3.Innovation Pitch (Deep-Dive) *Round 3 & 4 (*Semi-Finals & Finale*)*	MP4 (Max 5 Mins)	• Live Prototype demonstration • Technical hurdle breakdown • Explanation of Model accuracy/efficiency

6.2 Technical Submission Guidelines

- **Originality & IP:** All source code and creative assets must be original. Use of pre-trained models (e.g., from HuggingFace, OpenAI…) is permitted but must be clearly documented in the Technical Pitch Deck. Solutions must be original and developed specifically for this Hackathon. Pre-existing commercial products are ineligible.
- **Data Ethics:** Teams must ensure that any datasets used are either public-domain, royalty-free, or properly licensed. Any AI bias mitigation efforts should be mentioned in the submission.
- **Video Specifications:**

- Resolution: 1920x1080 (16:9 Landscape).
- Audio: Clear voiceover in English (subtitles are encouraged).
- Music: Must be royalty-free to avoid copyright disqualification.

- **Portal Submission:** All links (GitHub, Demo, Cloud Folders for Videos) must be accessible to the Jury. Private repositories or restricted-access links will lead to immediate disqualification.

6.3. Evaluation Criteria

- **Innovation & Originality (25%)**: Uniqueness of the AI application.
- **Technical Execution (30%)**: Complexity, robustness of the code, & effective use of AI tools.
- **Impact & Feasibility (30%)**: Potential to solve real-world ASEAN problems and scalability.
- **Presentation & Demo (15%)**: Quality of the pitch and functionality of the prototype.

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